WEEK 5 · LECTURE L2 · UNIT I

From Feedback to Development Conversation

Coaching models and evidence, managers' beliefs about change, why feedback is ignored, and candor across cultures.

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AFTER THIS LECTURE YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO

What this lecture prepares you for

- Structure a development conversation using the GROW model.
- Evaluate the meta analytic evidence on workplace coaching.
- Explain how managers' beliefs about ability shape whether they coach.
- Adapt candid feedback to a high power distance culture.

COURSE OUTCOMES

CLO 1 (design performance management systems) and CLO 5 (create development conversations).

COMMIT BEFORE THEORY

Some managers are natural coaches; the rest cannot be taught.

Agree or disagree. What would change your mind?

A CONVERSATION STRUCTURE · WHITMORE (2017)

The GROW model

GOAL

What do you want from this conversation and this quarter?

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REALITY

What is happening now? What have you tried?

›

OPTIONS

What could you do? What else?

›

WILL

What will you do, by when, and how will we know?

GROW is autonomy supportive by design: the employee generates the options.

THEORY IN DEPTH · THEEBOOM, BEERSMA AND VAN VIANEN (2014); JONES, WOODS AND GUILLAUME (2016)

Does coaching work?

THE CORE IDEA

Workplace coaching has positive effects on performance, skills, wellbeing, coping, attitudes and self regulation.

HOW IT WORKS

Jones et al. found effects were stronger for internal coaches than external ones.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Few studies, varied designs and many self reported outcomes.

IN PRACTICE

A firm trains senior engineers as internal coaches for new team leads instead of hiring outside coaches.

EXAM LENS

Cite both meta analyses for the evidence; note the small number of studies as a limit.

THEORY IN DEPTH · HESLIN, VANDEWALLE AND LATHAM (2006)

Why some managers coach

THE CORE IDEA

Managers who believe ability can grow coach more than managers who believe it is fixed.

HOW IT WORKS

In an experiment, a short self persuasion workshop shifted fixed beliefs and increased willingness to coach.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Willingness is not the same as coaching skill or sustained practice.

IN PRACTICE

Before a coaching program, a bank runs a session on how people improve, to shift branch heads' beliefs.

EXAM LENS

Use it to argue that manager capability is a lever, not a fixed constraint, in any system that relies on managers.

Feedback must be perceived, accepted, and acted on

PERCEIVED

The recipient must notice the feedback

›

ACCEPTED

Acceptance depends on the credibility and power of the source

›

ACTED ON

Only accepted feedback leads to a response

CANDOR ACROSS CULTURES

Radical candor in an Indian workplace

THE MODEL · SCOTT (2017)

Care personally and challenge directly at the same time.

POWER DISTANCE · HOFSTEDE (2001)

India scores high on power distance, where open challenge of or by a superior can threaten face.

TRANSLATION

Directness may need privacy, relationship first, and questions rather than verdicts.

COMPARE AND EVALUATE

Telling versus coaching

	Telling	Coaching (GROW)
Who generates options	Manager	Employee
Motivation it builds	Compliance	Ownership and competence
Speed	Fast	Slower at first
Best when	Urgent, safety critical tasks	Development and complex problems

PRACTICE FOR THE END TERM EXAMINATION

Questions to rehearse

"Coaching is the most important skill of a manager in a continuous performance system." Discuss with evidence. **20 marks**

A strong answer: explains GROW; uses the two meta analyses; uses Heslin et al. on manager beliefs; notes limits and culture.

How should a manager give candid feedback in a high power distance Indian workplace? **20 marks**

A strong answer: uses Scott, Hofstede and Ilgen et al.; designs a conversation; addresses face and acceptance.

Explain the GROW model. **10 marks**

A strong answer: names and explains each step; one example question per step.

CARRY THESE INTO THE EXAMINATION

Three things to remember

1. Coaching works, and internal coaches showed stronger effects
2. Managers' beliefs about ability decide whether they coach
3. Feedback that is not accepted is not acted on

SET READINGS · FROM THE LESSON PLAN

Read for this lecture

Kaplan, R. S., & Norton, D. P. (1996). *The balanced scorecard: Translating strategy into action*. Harvard Business School Press. Chapter 1.

Whitmore, J. (2017). *Coaching for performance* (5th ed.). Nicholas Brealey. Chapter on the GROW model.

Cappelli, P., & Tavis, A. (2016). The performance management revolution. *Harvard Business Review, 94*(10), 58–67.

HOW TO USE THESE

These are the Week 5 set readings. Whitmore (2017) is the core reading for this lecture.

Sources for this lecture (1 of 2)

Works named on the slides of this lecture. They are background sources, not set readings.

Heslin, P. A., Vandewalle, D., & Latham, G. P. (2006). Keen to help? Managers' implicit person theories and their subsequent employee coaching. *Personnel Psychology, 59*(4), 871–902. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1744-6570.2006.00057.x

Hofstede, G. (2001). *Culture's consequences: Comparing values, behaviors, institutions, and organizations across nations* (2nd ed.). Sage.

Ilgen, D. R., Fisher, C. D., & Taylor, M. S. (1979). Consequences of individual feedback on behavior in organizations. *Journal of Applied Psychology, 64*(4), 349–371. https://doi.org/10.1037/0021-9010.64.4.349

Sources for this lecture (2 of 2)

Jones, R. J., Woods, S. A., & Guillaume, Y. R. F. (2016). The effectiveness of workplace coaching: A meta analysis of learning and performance outcomes from coaching. *Journal of Occupational and Organizational Psychology, 89*(2), 249–277. https://doi.org/10.1111/joop.12119

Scott, K. (2017). *Radical candor*. St. Martin's Press.

Theeboom, T., Beersma, B., & van Vianen, A. E. M. (2014). Does coaching work? A meta analysis on the effects of coaching on individual level outcomes in an organizational context. *Journal of Positive Psychology, 9*(1), 1–18. https://doi.org/10.1080/17439760.2013.837499

Whitmore, J. (2017). *Coaching for performance* (5th ed.). Nicholas Brealey.